

Heuristic Evaluation

Structure of the individual report

Part I: Your Name

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Part II: Project Description

Since I could not attend the lectures, I thought of contacting people from other groups to find a way for me to heuristically evaluate their projects, but it was already a later stage of development for which it was not necessary anymore, so I decided to auto-evaluate my project for the purpose of fulfilling this further assignment for the exam.

Part III: Evaluation Execution

The heuristic evaluation was conducted at my place using the computer and the mobile phone as devices to deploy and test my prototype, and a paper to note all the observations. In a word file I had identified the heuristics to conduct. The information provided was of course enough because I had plain knowledge about my application's design and aims. To discover heuristic issues, I referred to Nielsen's 10 principles, I read each plausible violation that could be identified, and I looked for something in my application that could violate those important principles one at a time. I took multiple checks to try to spot as many violations as possible.

Part IV: List of Violations

Issue #1. H3 User control and freedom

- **Where:** Report Sighting Page – Map Interaction
- **What:** Users cannot retract an already inserted paw marker because at each click even on the same zone a new marker is inserted.
- **Why:** It lacks "emergency exits" capabilities for users who got the wrong type and want to recover from the error
- **Severity:** 2

Issue #2. H4 Consistency and standards

- **Where:** Home Page – Navigation Buttons
- **What:** The primary action button on the Home page is labeled "Read Articles," while the "Check" functionality (identified as a core user need) is relegated to the bottom navigation bar.
- **Why:** This violates the expectation of having the most critical "Safety" and "Tracking" tasks prioritized on the landing screen, potentially confusing users looking for the "Check" feature.

- **Severity:** 3

Issue #3. H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use

- **Where:** Settings Page – Notifications
- **What:** To enable notifications for new articles, the user is sent to a general "Language and Notifications" menu rather than a specific toggle.
- **Why:** It lacks "accelerators" for frequent tasks, requiring unnecessary clicks and cognitive load to find a specific setting within a nested menu.
- **Severity:** 2

Issue #4. H10 Help and documentation

- **Where:** Home Page – Tutorial
- **What:** The tutorial only appears once for new users based on a metadata flag.
- **Why:** There is no dedicated "Help" section or button to re-trigger the tutorial if a user forgets how a complex task (like "Wild Challenge") works after their first session.
- **Severity:** 1

Issue #5. H3 User control and freedom

- **Where:** Home Page – Species Guide
- **What:** When the user enters the section, he has no possibility to go back to the previous visualization
- **Why:** There is no possibility to click a back arrow or any similar button to go to the previous step of the path, so the user does not feel like he can recover from errors and must find alternative buttons to click to exit
- **Severity:** 2

Issue #6. H3 User control and freedom

- **Where:** Games – Wil Quiz – Select Quiz
- **What:** When the user enters the section, he has no possibility to go back to the previous visualization
- **Why:** There is no possibility to click a back arrow or any similar button to go to the previous step of the path, so the user does not feel like he can recover from errors and must find alternative buttons to click to exit
- **Severity:** 2

Issue #7 H1 Visibility of system status

- **Where:** Report Sighting Page – Take Photo
- **What:** after taking/uploading a picture and submitting it, the user knows if the operation is successfully completed thanks to the pop-up message, but can't keep track of the uploaded file
- **Why:** there is no clear display of an already updated picture
- **Severity:** 3

Issue #8 H1 User control and freedom

- **Where:** Report Sighting Page – Take Photo
- **What:** after taking/uploading a picture and submitting it, the user knows if the operation is successfully completed thanks to the pop-up message, but can't keep track of the uploaded file
- **Why:** connected to the problem in the issue #7, if there is no clear display of an already updated picture, the user can't discard it and eventually replace it if he wanted to
- **Severity:** 2

Issue #9 H4 Consistency and standard

- **Where:** Report Sighting Page – Record Audio / Upload Audio
- **What:** the user clicks one of the two alternatives thinking he will be redirected to the voice memos, but it does not happen
- **Why:** clicking one of these two buttons redirects to the camera or the gallery, so the user can't access audio functionalities (probably for an error in the code that I have not been able to solve even though I already specified to consider the voice memos)
- **Severity:** 3

Issue #10. H5 Error prevention

- **Where:** Games Page – Wild Challenge – Create Challenge
- **What:** The inputs for endDate and endTime appear to be standard text or basic date inputs without validation logic to prevent selecting past dates.
- **Why:** A user could accidentally set a challenge to end in the past, which would make the challenge immediately "expired" upon creation without any warning from the system.
- **Severity:** 3

Issue #11. H6 Recognition rather than recall

- **Where:** Report – Species Name Input
- **What:** The Species Name field is a plain text Input rather than an auto-complete or searchable dropdown.
- **Why:** Users must exactly recall and correctly spell the name of an animal (e.g., "Mountain Goat" vs "Goat"). This places a high memory load on the user compared to recognizing a name from a suggested list.
- **Severity:** 2

Issue #12. H7 Flexibility and efficiency of use

- **Where:** Home Page – Species Guide
- **What:** The categories (Terrestrial, Aquatic, etc.) are displayed as cards, but there is no search or filter functionality within the guide itself.
- **Why:** As the "database" of animals grows, users who know exactly what animal they are looking for will find it inefficient to scroll through broad categories to find a specific entry.
- **Severity:** 1

Issue #13. H8 Aesthetic and minimalist design

- **Where:** Home Page – Layout.
- **What:** The Home page contains multiple large cards for "Species Guide," "Recent Sightings," "Check Your Maps," "Adventure Essentials," and "Premium Plans" all on one scrolling view.
- **Why:** This creates a very long page that may overwhelm the user with irrelevant information (like premium ads) when they just want to quickly "Report" or "Check" a sighting.
- **Severity:** 2

Part V: Summary and Recommendations

Report in the table below the total number of identified violations.

Heuristic	# violations
H1: Visibility of system status	2
H2: Match between system and the real world	0
H3: User control and freedom	3
H4: Consistency and standards	2
H5: Error prevention	1
H6: Recognition rather than recall	1
H7: Flexibility and efficiency of use	2
H8: Aesthetic and minimalist design	1
H9: Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors	0
H10: Help and documentation	1
HN: Non-heuristic issue	0

The **WildCall** application exhibits a very strong alignment with its value proposition: "A bridge between People and the Planet". The aesthetic choice of a nature-inspired palette (forest green, warm orange, and earthy tones) creates a cohesive "organic" feel that matches the environmental domain. The use of a mobile-first BottomNav significantly enhances the efficiency of use for its primary target audience, which is hikers and travelers who interact with the device while on the move.

To improve the interface, the primary focus should be on Information Architecture and Navigation. Replacing the "Read Articles" button on the Home page with a "Check Path" action would align the

interface with the user's primary safety needs. Furthermore, the application would benefit from a "Social/Community" hub; currently, features like the "Friends List" exist in settings but are not integrated into the main workflow, which could limit engagement for the "Wild Challenge" tasks. Moreover, implementing a "Replay Tutorial" option in the settings would ensure that complex gamification features remain accessible to returning or less "digital savvy" users.

Finally, try to make the pages as shortest as possible so that all relevant information and operations are at hand and the user does not feel overwhelmed by a cluttered environment, especially in the first page, so redistribute the cards across the overall application (ex. moving the update about recent sightings by the community into the Report Page which is also coherent, about issue #13).